The Train for Another Day

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 11

Train had a splendid folding railway picture. Nib wanted to put it on display at once. The Farm Quay request assigned that very book to a waiting borrower. Lark set the display tray beside the next-delivery tray so the difference could be seen as well as read.

“An excellent day for a train,” Nib exclaimed. “And a reader who requested one,” Lark added kindly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **out**

“Ai in train and rain writes long a,” Lark modeled clearly. “Ay in day and play can write that same sound. Compare them with a and silent e in make. The sound can match while the actual spelling stays different.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try train, rain, day, play. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read Train on the request,” Lark invited gently. “Which tray serves the reader who asked for it?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The train is in the rain. I can play by the cart.**

“What is in the rain?” Lark asked gently. “Find the subject of the first sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib placed Train in the next-delivery tray and left the display book in its own place. The loan remained unrecorded while the boat approached Farm Quay. At the landing, an old direction board pointed toward closed bank stairs. A newer note showed a floating pontoon with an attached ramp.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write train beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew Train ready for its reader. The impressive foldout could wait to open in the right hands. First, the crew needed to use Farm Quay's current landing rather than its old closed stairs.